

Frank Nowicki

Linux Systems Administrator · Infrastructure Engineering, Automation & Security Compliance

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Clearance: Previously cleared — SF-86 investigation completed and clearance held during federal-facing work at SourceHOV/Exela. Eligible for and able to obtain Public Trust.

SUMMARY

Linux systems administrator with 20+ years running RHEL, CentOS, Ubuntu, SUSE, and Solaris in production across development, test, and production environments. Work has spanned more than one technical discipline by design — infrastructure operations and engineering, application support, database administration, network and telecommunications, and software engineering — which is what made me the escalation point for complex, cross-boundary problems nobody could isolate to a single team. Root-cause ownership took one enterprise estate from roughly 300 monthly incidents to 80 and turned a failure-prone environment into a standardized, monitored, documented platform. Strong on provisioning, patching, and hardening; monitoring, capacity, and performance tuning; and Ansible/Shell/Python automation that removes manual effort permanently. AWS Certified Solutions Architect and SysOps Administrator; Oracle Database 12c Certified Professional; Red Hat administration and security training.

CORE SKILLS

Linux Administration	RHEL, CentOS, Ubuntu, SUSE, Solaris 8–11 — provisioning and build standardization, patching and lifecycle management, kernel tuning, systemd services, LVM and filesystem management across development, test, and production estates
Automation	Ansible, Shell/Bash, Python (Django, Flask, Pandas, asyncio), Perl, PowerShell; Puppet, Chef, Jenkins; golden-build standardization, provisioning automation, CI/CD pipelines, scripted remediation of recurring failure classes
Security & Hardening	SELinux policy, service hardening, firewall configuration, configuration-baseline definition and enforcement, patch compliance, secure file transfer; Red Hat security administration training
Monitoring & Performance	System health, capacity, and performance monitoring; alerting and process-threshold management; log management and analysis; performance tuning and capacity planning; proactive degradation detection
Access & Authentication	User account lifecycle and access-control administration in mixed Unix/Windows estates; automated account provisioning; directory and name services (LDAP, DNS, NFS); privilege and permission standards
Application & Database Support	Supporting application teams on infrastructure, dependency, and environment issues; web, mail, and FTP/SFTP service administration; Oracle 12c (certified) and PostgreSQL; test-environment parity and release coordination
Networking & Telecom	Cisco routing and switching (OSPF, EIGRP, STP), CCENT certified; telecom access configuration; load balancing and high-availability patterns; storage networking on EMC Isilon, Celerra, and NetApp
Documentation & Standards	Runbooks, build documentation, configuration baselines, and operational standards; release coordination across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources
Cloud & Containers	AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, IAM, Backup) — Solutions Architect & SysOps Administrator certified; Docker, Kubernetes, OpenStack; Cloudflare Workers, KV, and Pages; Azure

EXPERIENCE

Senior Unix/Linux System Administrator — SourceHOV / Exela

Oct 2011 – Jan 2017 · Troy, MI

- Senior technical escalation point for Linux and Unix across a neglected, failure-prone enterprise estate spanning development, test, and production; assessed it end to end, established configuration and operational standards, and rebuilt it into a stable, predictable, monitored platform. **Held a security clearance (SF-86) for this work.**
- Reduced monthly incident volume from roughly 300 tickets to 80 through root-cause analysis, proactive remediation, and reprioritization of recurring failure classes — fixing causes rather than reissuing workarounds.
- Designed and implemented monitoring, alerting, and log management for mail, web, and FTP services, introducing process-threshold management where none had existed and surfacing degradation before it reached users.
- Hardened and standardized system builds and patch levels across the estate, eliminating the configuration drift that was generating a large share of the recurring incident volume.
- Automated user-account provisioning and access-control changes, cutting a manual two-hour process to twenty minutes and removing a standing source of drift and permission error.
- Led a migration of 600+ users to a new secure FTP platform and relocated multiple file systems onto EMC Isilon scale-out storage — evaluated dependencies and rollback risk up front, completed both cutovers with zero data loss.
- Supported application teams directly on infrastructure, dependency, and environment problems, and maintained the runbooks and build documentation the rest of the team worked from.

Independent Cloud & Platform Developer — Self-Employed

2024 – Present · Remote

- Design and operate a production serverless backend on a global edge network — authenticated endpoints, scheduled sweep jobs, and key-value state — including a server-side dead-man's-switch verified end to end in unattended production testing.
- Diagnosed a silent multi-day production outage from user-visible symptoms alone, tracing a degraded fallback path to a credential removed from configuration and never re-provisioned as a secret; built a zero-cost authentication probe so the same failure mode is now detected in seconds rather than days.
- Re-architected a device-dependent notification path into a redundant server-side one across two independent delivery providers, eliminating a single point of failure in the alerting chain.
- Automated release delivery using Workload Identity Federation to satisfy a security policy prohibiting long-lived service-account keys; maintain five independent signing and release pipelines with distinct review and compliance requirements.

Career Break — Family Caregiving & Professional Development

2017 – 2023

- Full-time caregiver for a family member while maintaining and deepening technical skills through structured certification study.
- Earned **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** and **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018), and **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA).
- Completed Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration and security training — SELinux policy, firewall configuration, service hardening, monitoring, and performance tuning — alongside Docker, Kubernetes, Puppet, Ansible, and Python automation coursework.

Unix System Administrator — TEKsystems (Contract)

May 2007 – Jan 2008 · Warren, MI

- Built and maintained a production-parity test environment covering patch levels, security configuration, telecom access, and kernel tuning, so changes were validated against real production behavior before release.
- Coordinated releases across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources, aligning system configuration with application readiness each cycle.

Unix System Administrator — Incentra Solutions / DaimlerChrysler (SHAP)

Apr 2005 – Nov 2006 · Sterling Heights, MI

- Deployed and configured network-attached storage appliances backing up plant servers across multiple Chrysler facilities — on-site hardware and system build-out, then ongoing administration of Linux-based GuardianOS, DNS, and NFS.
- Led migration of Unix and Windows clients from NetBackup to NetVault across Solaris 2.6–9 environments, evaluating per-client dependencies and sequencing cutovers around production windows.

Unix System Administrator — LaSalle Bank (Contract)

Jun 2004 – Jan 2005 · Troy, MI

- Wrote Bash automation for EMC Celerra volume creation and rsync-based replication; built mirrored volumes with Solstice DiskSuite and standardized Solaris 8 post-installation through JumpStart imaging for repeatable, documented builds.

Systems Engineer — Technical Solutions, LLC

Jun 1997 – Jun 2003 · Troy, MI

- Pre- and post-sales engineering: technical presentations, proofs of concept, client product integration, and Level 2/3 escalation support — translating between customer requirements and system implementation.

WHAT COLLEAGUES SAY

"Frank was the senior Unix admin when I worked with him at SourceHOV. He expertly fixed a neglected Unix environment, proactively configured systems so they no longer failed, and added value by putting monitoring in place and setting standards. Under his leadership it became a stable, predictable platform. He is one of the very best Unix admins I have worked with and would be a benefit to any company that hires him."

— Steve Allison, Backup and Recovery Engineer · worked with Frank at SourceHOV

"Frank is an awesome System Administrator. Professional. Effective. Solution-oriented. Looking forward to working with Frank again soon."

— Kuldip Bhatt, Senior Technology & CRM Operations Leader

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** (2018) · **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018)
- **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA) — Global Institute of Information Technology
- **Cisco Certified Entry Networking Technician (CCENT)** — Cisco Networking Academy
- **Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration and security training** — system administration, SELinux, hardening, monitoring, and performance tuning
- **Associate of Applied Science, Information Technology** — Macomb Community College
- **Unix/C Certificate Program** — Marygrove College: Unix system and network administration, shell scripting, C programming